

COLLECTION · SELLERS

Selling your condo

*Documents, fees and co-ownership-specific
pitfalls*

READ BEFORE YOU BEGIN

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Selling your condo

Documents, fees and co-ownership-specific pitfalls

Selling a condo isn't selling a house: the buyer also buys a share of a co-ownership, with its finances, its rules and its history. A well-prepared file reassures the buyer and speeds up the sale.

This guide covers the documents to gather, how to present the fees and the contingency fund, and the pitfalls specific to selling in co-ownership.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My notes” page.

Selling a condo isn't selling a house: co-ownership adds documents, collective figures and typical buyers. This guide shows you how to prepare the file, present the building's finances, market it and avoid the pitfalls specific to condos.

The idea: turn co-ownership life into an argument for trust.

CHAPTER

Preparing the co-ownership file

Gathering in advance what the buyer will require.

- Declaration of co-ownership and building bylaws.
- Financial statements, budget and the up-to-date amount of the fees.
- Contingency fund balance, fund study, maintenance logbook.
- Minutes of the latest meetings.
- Insurance certificate and the status of any special assessments voted.

An informed, reassured buyer negotiates less and backs out less. Preparing this file in advance is a sale accelerator.

A condo buyer (and their notary, their lender) will require the co-ownership file: declaration, bylaws, financial statements, contingency fund, meeting minutes.

Gathering it in advance speeds up the sale and projects an image of sound management.

EMILIE'S TIP

Gather the co-ownership file BEFORE you even list. When the buyer asks for the documents and everything is ready, you inspire confidence and keep the momentum.

CHAPTER

Presenting fees and the contingency fund

Turning a sensitive point into an argument for trust.

The fees and the health of the contingency fund are scrutinized by savvy buyers. A solid fund and realistic fees are selling points; a weak fund will be a negotiating point.

- Highlight a well-capitalized contingency fund and a well-managed building.
- Be transparent about any special assessment voted or upcoming.
- Explain what the fees cover (services, maintenance, reserve).

The fees and the health of the contingency fund are closely scrutinized: present them clearly rather than being on the defensive. A well-stocked fund and a transparent management history become arguments for trust — not weaknesses.

EMILIE'S TIP

A solid contingency fund is a selling point, not just an obligation. Put it forward: it reassures the buyer that there won't be nasty surprises down the road.

CHAPTER

Marketing a condo

Showcasing the strengths specific to co-ownership.

- Highlight the location, the building's amenities (elevator, gym, terrace) and the “maintenance-free” lifestyle.
- Home staging suited to small spaces: declutter, maximize light and the sense of space.
- Target the right buyer (first-time buyer, professional, retiree downsizing) depending on the condo.

A condo sells on a lifestyle as much as on square footage: tell the story of that lifestyle.

For a condo, showcase what's specific to it: location, the building's amenities, low maintenance, security, parking. Target the lifestyle your unit enables — it's often that, more than the size, that triggers the crush.

EMILIE'S TIP

Sell the lifestyle: proximity, security, amenities, maintenance-free freedom. For many condo buyers, that's the real product.

CHAPTER

The specific pitfalls to avoid

Anticipating what derails a condo sale.

- Incomplete or missing documents: they delay and worry the buyer.
- Undisclosed special assessment: a source of withdrawal or litigation.
- Declaration restrictions (renting, pets) that put off some buyers: to be clarified early.
- Known building problems (leaks, litigation): better addressed frankly.

Transparency about the co-ownership is your best ally: it avoids the surprises that sink a transaction at the last minute.

The classic pitfalls: incomplete or missing documents (they delay and worry), a weak contingency fund, undisclosed co-ownership litigation, ignored restrictive rules.

Anticipate them: those are what derail a condo sale at the last minute.

EMILIE'S TIP

Never let the buyer discover a special assessment or a building dispute on their own. What you disclose frankly can be negotiated; what's discovered scares off or leads to a lawsuit.

CHAPTER

Who is your condo for?

Tailoring the sale to the typical buyer.

A condo doesn't sell to “everyone”. Identifying your **typical buyer** helps you present it better:

- **First-time buyer:** sensitive to price, fees and proximity to services.
- **Downsizer** (retiree): looking for comfort, quiet and little maintenance.
- **Investor:** looks at the return, whether renting is allowed and the fees.

Put forward the arguments that speak to your most likely buyer: location, lifestyle, or profitability.

Tailor your marketing to the most likely buyer: a first-time buyer sensitive to price and fees, a retiree seeking quiet, or an investor attentive to return and whether renting is allowed. The same condo, two different pitches depending on the target.

EMILIE'S TIP

Tailor your marketing to the most likely buyer of YOUR condo. A 3½ near the metro sells to a first-time buyer; a large, quiet condo appeals to a retiree. The same property, two pitches.

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

Your next steps, concretely.

This week

1. Gather the complete co-ownership file.
2. Check the state of the contingency fund and the assessments.

Within 30 days

1. Prepare a reassuring presentation of the fees and the fund.
2. Adapt the home staging to condo spaces.

Next

1. Go to market targeting the right buyer, with Emilie.

Before listing

1. Gather the complete co-ownership file (declaration, finances, minutes).
2. Identify my typical buyer and adapt my pitch.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Co-ownership file: the set of documents to provide to the buyer.
 - Contingency fund: collective savings for major work, an argument for trust.
 - Special assessment: an exceptional sum to disclose if voted or upcoming.
 - Co-ownership fees: charges covering services, maintenance and reserve.
 - Condo home staging: showcasing suited to small spaces.
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- Co-ownership file: the set of documents required by the buyer.
 - Contingency fund: collective reserve; its health reassures or worries.
 - Co-ownership fees: monthly management and maintenance charges.
 - Meeting minutes: the history of the building's decisions and problems.
 - Typical buyer: the most likely profile, which guides the marketing.

GOING FURTHER

Quiz — test your knowledge

1. When you sell a condo, the buyer also buys:

- A) Nothing more
- B) A share of the co-ownership and its history
- C) The whole building
- D) The neighbouring lot

2. The co-ownership file should be ready:

- A) After the sale
- B) Before you even list
- C) Never
- D) At the notary only

3. A solid contingency fund is:

- A) A disadvantage
- B) A reassuring selling point
- C) Unimportant
- D) A secret

4. A voted special assessment must be:

- A) Hidden
- B) Disclosed transparently
- C) Ignored
- D) Paid by the buyer without telling them

5. A condo sells above all on:

- A) Square footage alone
- B) A lifestyle (location, amenities, maintenance-free)
- C) The Welcome Tax
- D) The basement

6. A frequent pitfall is:

- A) A complete file
- B) Incomplete or missing documents
- C) Too much transparency
- D) A good fund

7. Restrictions (renting, pets) must be:

- A) Hidden
- B) Clarified early
- C) Invented
- D) Ignored

8. The best ally in a condo sale is:

- A) Opacity
- B) Transparency about the co-ownership
- C) Haste
- D) Silence

Answer key

- 1. **B** — They join the community (intro and ch. 1).
- 2. **B** — It reassures and keeps the momentum (ch. 1).
- 3. **B** — It reassures that there are no surprises (ch. 2).
- 4. **B** — Transparency avoids withdrawal and litigation (ch. 2 and 4).
- 5. **B** — You tell the lifestyle story (ch. 3).
- 6. **B** — It delays and worries the buyer (ch. 4).
- 7. **B** — They can put off some buyers (ch. 4).
- 8. **B** — It avoids last-minute surprises (ch. 4).

Signé PAR Em

*Thank you for reading. May this guide help you
decide with confidence, with all the information
in hand.*

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